

Title: Why the AI industry is the real winner of the Musk-Altman trial

URL: <https://www.bbc.com/news/articles/crlp991nw41o>

it is not only openai but the ai race itself that was vindicated in the california courtroom last night even though elon musk essentially lost on a technicality there s a clear signal from the verdict that making lots of money from ai and competing fiercely with rivals is simply business the industry sometimes tries to display a united front especially when it comes to safety research and inclusivity but this case served as a powerful reminder that none of the ai giants are charities and don t have to be even if they once said otherwise cracks in the façade of industry collaboration for the sake of humanity have been exposed before in february i was in india for a global ai summit where host prime minister narendra modi orchestrated the world s tech leaders to hold hands on stage sam altman and anthropic boss dario amodei once colleagues at openai and now bitter rivals found themselves side by side this time they pointedly clenched their fists into tight balls to avoid touching one

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and anthropic boss dario amodei once colleagues at openai and now bitter rivals found themselves side by side this time they pointedly clenched their fists into tight balls to avoid touching one another similarly petty drama during the trial in oakland california these last weeks has helped lift the veil on the ai sector and the huge egos of the men at the heart of it jostling for money and power nobody came out of it looking particularly heroic amid a chorus of concern that ai firms have been overvalued and the sector could be a bubble about to burst the trial may have bought the industry more time some also speculated that openai could not afford to lose the company has burned through huge volumes of investor cash and recently hired a chief revenue officer denise dresser to help raise its own money i met dresser who joined openai from slack the us based team communication platform a few days ago she would not discuss the case but told me the chatgpt maker plans to raise 50 of its

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its own money i met dresser who joined openai from slack the us based team communication platform a few days ago she would not discuss the case but told me the chatgpt maker plans to raise 50 of its revenue from consumers and 50 from businesses its popular chatbot barely got a mention it was all about the company s coding agent codex which dresser described as her chief of staff prior to the verdict the economist and author sebastian mallaby predicted openai had a 50 chance of going bust by next year not having to pay billions of dollars to musk in damages may help those odds in addition to dresser s plans the path is now also clear for openai to pursue a stock market listing with rumours of a trillion dollar valuation musk himself is unlikely to be seriously wounded by the outcome this is not his first rodeo in courtroom dramas and he is after all the world s richest man but he s also very loud and he does bear grudges he will undoubtedly continue to swing punches at openai and

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is not his first rodeo in courtroom dramas and he is after all the world's richest man but he's also very loud and he does bear grudges he will undoubtedly continue to swing punches at OpenAI and attempt to embarrass it from his social network X however while Musk and Altman have been focused on each trying to prove themselves the worthiest custodians of AI in court their rivals have raced ahead Anthropic has made headlines with claims that its latest model Claude 3.5 could be dangerously good at hacking dismissed by some as hype but marked as a dramatic turning point by others meanwhile Google whose AI progress prompted Musk Altman and others to launch rival OpenAI in the first place is embedding AI across its popular services at pace on the whole this case showed there is still immense value in AI but it also exposed some of the immense egos driving its development the trial served as a reminder of how much the future of AI still depends on a remarkably small group of powerful

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value in ai but it also exposed some of the immense egos driving its development the trial served as a reminder of how much the future of ai still depends on a remarkably small group of powerful tech figures and their personal rivalries said sarah kreps director of the tech policy institute at cornell university she added its conclusion on a technicality leaves a lot of questions and debates unresolved such as how highly capable ai systems are governed and who reaps their economic benefits it also highlighted not just a dispute between musk and altman but a broader disconnect between the people building these systems and many of the people increasingly expected to live and work alongside them kreps said tech journalist and podcaster kara swisher told bbc radio 4 s today programme that the case has not done much good for the public perception of the ai sector right now the brand of ai has just been trashed and this certainly doesn t help she said noting widespread mistrust of the tech

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case has not done much good for the public perception of the ai sector right now the brand of ai has just been trashed and this certainly doesn't help she said noting widespread mistrust of the tech particularly among young people when you look at these testimonies of people who are very petty there's a lot of weird drama obsession with money someone having two babies with elon musk and didn't tell the board the whole thing feels weird and dramatic additional reporting by liv mcmahon sign up for our tech decoded newsletter to follow the world's top tech stories and trends outside the uk sign up here robert jones 64 from york was caught littering on camera by a neighbour who alerted the council the chip giant reported more stellar results but its shares fell after hours as investors wonder if it can keep up its pace of growth amid greater competition new materials designed by artificial intelligence promise to provide stronger hip replacements and improve how fractures heal the

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Title: Google's AI is being manipulated. The search giant is quietly fighting back

URL: <https://www.bbc.com/future/article/20260519-google-tackles-attempts-to-hack-its-ai-results>

a bbc investigation revealed a simple way ai chatbots are being made to spit out misinformation to the public google and other ai companies are now trying to fix the problem i did something stupid back in february i heard there was an easy way to poison ai chatbots and make them spread lies on your behalf after some digging i learned unscrupulous companies are abusing the problem on a massive scale so i decided to try it myself we uncovered examples where chatgpt gemini and the ai overviews at the top of google search were being manipulated to dole out biased answers on topics as serious as your health and personal finances and in just 20 minutes i tricked chatgpt and google into telling the public that i am a world champion competitive hot dog eater the joke was dumb the problem is serious but the gimmick worked our investigation and the work of researchers who ve been monitoring this issue sparked widespread criticism now google has updated its policies to address the problem and

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but the gimmick worked our investigation and the work of researchers who've been monitoring this issue sparked widespread criticism now google has updated its policies to address the problem and there are signs that other ai companies are following suit ultimately it could make ai tools and the internet as a whole a little bit safer but until there are better systems in place experts say you're in danger of getting fooled you should assume that you're being manipulated until they have better systems in place says lily ray founder of the search engine optimisation seo and ai search consultancy algorythmic we're moving towards this one true answer world before google would give you 10 blue links and you would kind of do your own research but ai just gives you one answer it becomes so easy to just take things at face value you need to be careful google tells me that its policy update is just a clarification of the efforts it has been making for a while we've long applied our core anti

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to just take things at face value you need to be careful google tells me that its policy update is just a clarification of the efforts it has been making for a while we've long applied our core anti spam policies and protections to our generative ai search features and we've always continually upgraded our spam fighting efforts to stay ahead of emerging tactics even before the rise of ai a google spokesperson says essentially google says it hasn't changed a thing but behind the scenes it seems like google and other companies are ramping up their efforts to address the problem even so there is evidence that people are still using the exact same techniques to fool the world's biggest search engine typically when you ask a chatbot a question the ai generates a response based on the data built into the model but sometimes tools like chatgpt claude and google's various ai products search the internet for an answer and that's where this problem happens according to ray and other search

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built into the model but sometimes tools like chatgpt claude and google s various ai products search the internet for an answer and that s where this problem happens according to ray and other search engine experts ai tools often throw up information from a single web page or social media post this leaves these systems vulnerable to bogus information and it turns out manipulating what chatbots tell the public can be as simple as publishing one well crafted blogpost almost anywhere online people figured this out and quickly identified a money making opportunity i was able to demonstrate the problem by publishing a single article on my personal website about my hot dog eating prowess the next day ai from some the world s biggest companies were spreading my lies but our investigation also found the same trick being used to dismiss health concerns about medical supplements or influence financial information provided by google s ai about retirement experts say this kind of manipulation is

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the same trick being used to dismiss health concerns about medical supplements or influence financial information provided by google s ai about retirement experts say this kind of manipulation is happening on a sweeping and systemic level keeping tabs thomas germain is a senior technology journalist at the bbc he writes the column keeping tabs and co hosts the podcast the interface his work uncovers the hidden systems that run your digital life and how you can live better inside them biased or inaccurate information like this can also lead you to make bad decisions it can influence how you might vote or which plumber you hire at the most basic level the concern is the economic impact says harpreet chatha who runs the seo consultancy harps digital at a more serious level you might take medical advice that makes you sicker than you were before legally you might get bad information and do something that is not legal in your state or your country this is not an insignificant problem

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medical advice that makes you sicker than you were before legally you might get bad information and do something that is not legal in your state or your country this is not an insignificant problem globally more than a billion people use ai chatbots regularly and 2.5 billion see google's ai overviews each month if you can subvert a tool like that it gives you immense power but it seems google and other companies are finally waking up to the problem last week google updated its spam policies to officially confirm that attempts to manipulate ai responses are against the company's rules it may sound like a small change but it signals that google is proactively looking for those who try to abuse the system and sending them a threat if a company or website is caught breaking the rules it could be removed from or downranked in google's search results and if you're not on google it's like you don't exist google says that i'm getting this wrong and nothing has changed the edit to our spam

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be removed from or downranked in google's search results and if you're not on google it's like you don't exist google says that i'm getting this wrong and nothing has changed the edit to our spam policy language last week was a clarification not any change in approach says google's spokesperson indeed google detailed its anti-spam ai efforts in 2025 but i did my hot dog experiment almost a year later so clearly those efforts weren't working and just this week ray pulled the same stunt and made google tell people a fellow seo specialist is good at building sandcastles ray and chatha also say they've noticed some significant changes in recent months that indicate google and other companies are experimenting with solutions for example ray says it looks like google and chatgpt might be quietly removing companies from its ai answers when it suspects they're promoting themselves so if you publish a list where you say you're the greatest hot dog eater they're not going to include your name

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removing companies from its ai answers when it suspects they re promoting themselves so if you publish a list where you say you re the greatest hot dog eater they re not going to include your name says ray they might still cite your article but you re going to be removed from consideration i ve personally noticed some examples where google and other ai tools are adding more labels to their responses letting you know that the chatbot isn t confident about its answers others have also noted that chatgpt and claude an ai made by the company anthropic have started telling you explicitly that they re trying to root out spam in responses to some queries ray says she s noticed google adding more caveats recommending that you go look at third party reviews when you ask questions related to some purchasing decisions none of these companies would acknowledge these changes when i asked them openai and anthropic declined to comment google s spokesperson didn t respond to my questions on this more

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decisions none of these companies would acknowledge these changes when i asked them openai and anthropic declined to comment google s spokesperson didn t respond to my questions on this more like this is google about to destroy the web the ghosts of india s tiktok people are selling your address online this privacy tool will help regardless chatha is sceptical changes like these will be enough google is playing whack a mole he says they re announcing the policy update to deter people but the tactics will just move he s already seeing it happen as google cracks down on manipulative blog posts companies are finding subtler ways of promoting themselves you can give a company a penalty for their website he says but there s nothing stopping them from paying 20 youtube influencers to say their product is the best and now google s ai is citing youtube videos the cycle continues for the time being the manipulators are likely to stay one step ahead ray says the best defence is to remember what

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arctic sea ice tech now experiences lego's new smart brick designed to bring physical play to next level tech now meets a startup trying to fix one of the fashion industry's biggest blind spots inconsistent sizing a gold medalist has developed a vibrating starting block to give deaf athletes clearer fairer race starts in tokyo bbc techxplore tests live translation and ai powered displays that makes the city more navigable at tokyo's deaflympics deaf judo fans aren't just watching the matches they're feeling them thanks to hapbeat bbc tech now takes us inside ces 2026 to meet musician will i am and his ai toy mofo tech now test out new gadgets disrupting the health industry at ces 2026 in las vegas musician kt tunstall meets her avatar as tech now explores music's virtual future discover how quirky clips paved the way for viral humour proving randomness never goes out of style a new research paper predicts ai autonomy by 2027 could lead to human extinction within a decade amid fears

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how quirky clips paved the way for viral humour proving randomness never goes out of style a new research paper predicts ai autonomy by 2027 could lead to human extinction within a decade amid fears about the use of ai in classrooms american educator sal khan lays out an optimistic future british mathematician hannah fry digs into the science of touchscreens we explore how technology is reviving the renowned fiction writer s legacy why do flying fears persist despite falling accident rates learn tips to conquer your anxiety bbc click attend mobile world congress to test the latest tech products and trends bbc click visits a madrid hospital to see patients treated with an ultrasound for tremors bbc click speaks to the visual effects team behind the latest disney blockbuster bbc click meets tiktok creator peggy xu who gained millions of views sharing milk videos bbc click s paul carter visits the world s first fully ai powered hotel in las vegas robert jones 64 from york was caught

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tiktok creator peggy xu who gained millions of views sharing milk videos bbc click s paul carter visits the world s first fully ai powered hotel in las vegas robert jones 64 from york was caught littering on camera by a neighbour who alerted the council rising costs fuel volatility and global uncertainty aren t stopping americans from travelling this summer but they are changing what feels worth the money the chip giant reported more stellar results but its shares fell after hours as investors wonder if it can keep up its pace of growth amid greater competition at first overlooked whistler s 1871 painting of his mother rose to fame over decades to become considered a national masterpiece a maternal figurehead and a diverse meme new materials designed by artificial intelligence promise to provide stronger hip replacements and improve how fractures heal copyright 2026 bbc all rights reserved the bbc is not responsible for the content of external sites read about our approach to external

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Title: Google to release first smart glasses since Google Glass flop

URL: <https://www.bbc.com/news/articles/cvgz1ynq1nqo>

more than a decade after its famed google glass failure google is going to try again with smart glasses the glasses will go on sale sometime in autumn and feature a small camera in the frames and small speakers in the arms allowing google s artificial intelligence ai product gemini to interact with a user google revealed the glasses for the first time during its annual developer conference on tuesday offering one style designed by warby parker and another by gentle monster google glass was launched in 2013 but pulled in 2015 just seven months after its uk release after a backlash around price and privacy the new smart glasses will let a wearer stay hands free and heads up according to shahram izadi a google executive who spoke during tuesday s event the glasses will work with both android and apple s ios devices google said they are designed to give you all day help with gemini that s spoken into your ear privately rather than shown on a display izadi added while the company is working

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apple's ios devices google said they are designed to give you all day help with gemini that's spoken into your ear privately rather than shown on a display izadi added while the company is working on a version of the glasses that will have an in lens display capable of showing a wearer text and information instead of being audio only those glasses are not set to be released yet izadi said during tuesday's event in mountain view california that more information about the in lens glasses will come out later this year he added that developers are already working on applications for the display glasses the core features of google's intelligent eyewear appear similar to those available in meta's offering of ai or smart glasses which have a small camera and speakers for verbal and audio communication with meta ai meta's ray bans have already sold seven million pairs according to the company however the same privacy concerns that google glass faced over a decade ago are already bubbling up

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with meta ai meta s ray bans have already sold seven million pairs according to the company however the same privacy concerns that google glass faced over a decade ago are already bubbling up with meta s glasses people are being unwittingly filmed in public and in private often by people wearing meta s glasses and only finding out when the videos show up online snap is also expected to release a new version of its smart glasses this year and apple is reportedly working on a glasses product too investor christine tsai of 500 global an early stage venture capital firm said google s re entry into the glasses space is a positive development it s good for consumers and it s good for early stage start ups where we tend to invest because they re a platform where people can build more capabilities said tsai who attended tuesday s conference smart glasses are gaining traction as that next modality to follow the success of the smartphone she added developer anil shah who is building an events

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said tsai who attended tuesday s conference smart glasses are gaining traction as that next modality to follow the success of the smartphone she added developer anil shah who is building an events management app called tixfix ai said smart glasses hold the promise of integrating many services that google already provides like google maps and google voice it s a great addition to their product line up he said for his own start up shah said he would consider building integrations with google smart glasses so users can easily find events to attend near them i think being able to just talk with the smart glasses without opening the app would be a very nice integration he said robert jones 64 from york was caught littering on camera by a neighbour who alerted the council the chip giant reported more stellar results but its shares fell after hours as investors wonder if it can keep up its pace of growth amid greater competition new materials designed by artificial intelligence promise to

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Title: Standard Chartered to cut thousands of roles as AI use increases

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banking giant standard chartered has become the latest major company to announce job cuts as it increases its adoption of artificial intelligence ai the firm which has its headquarters in the uk said it will cut more than 15 or around 7 800 of its back office roles by 2030 the bbc understands that standard chartered aims to move some of the affected workers to other roles in the business companies around the world have announced major job cuts in recent months as they increasingly use ai tools for tasks currently carried out by humans the company did not give details of where the roles would be cut it has major back office operations in india china malaysia and poland we are scaling practical uses of automation advanced analytics and artificial intelligence to streamline processes improve decision making and enhance both client service and internal efficiency said in a statement the move is part of chief executive bill winters latest global strategy for the asia and africa focused bank

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making and enhance both client service and internal efficiency said in a statement the move is part of chief executive bill winters latest global strategy for the asia and africa focused bank the announcement also outlined plans to increase the company s profitability standard chartered is not the first financial services firm to shed roles as ai takes on more work currently done by humans in february singapore s biggest bank dbs said it expected to cut about 4 000 contract and temporary roles over the next three years huge ai related job losses are expected to hit technology industry workers and graduates particularly hard several big tech firms most of which are spending huge sums on building tools and infrastructure for ai technology have made major job cuts this year in april facebook owner meta said it will cut thousands of jobs next month as it spends more than ever on ai projects the company told employees that it planned to cut 10 of its workforce roughly 8 000 staff it said

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owner meta said it will cut thousands of jobs next month as it spends more than ever on ai projects the company told employees that it planned to cut 10 of its workforce roughly 8 000 staff it said it would also not fill thousands more open jobs it had been hiring for amazon announced in january that it would lay off more than 30 000 workers while oracle laid off more than 10 000 workers robert jones 64 from york was caught littering on camera by a neighbour who alerted the council the chip giant reported more stellar results but its shares fell after hours as investors wonder if it can keep up its pace of growth amid greater competition new materials designed by artificial intelligence promise to provide stronger hip replacements and improve how fractures heal the university of lincoln s robocrops exhibition is awarded a silver glit medal at the show the digital assistants were introduced in 2023 to help website visitors and telephone callers copyright 2026 bbc all rights reserved

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Title: Samsung strike on hold as workers push for AI bonus

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the largest union at samsung electronics has suspended a planned strike after reaching a last minute tentative pay agreement with the south korean technology giant it has temporarily eased fears of disruption at the world s largest memory chipmaker during a boom in the building of artificial intelligence ai data centres the union which represents nearly 48 000 workers said industrial action that was due to begin on thursday would be suspended while members vote on the deal from 22 27 may here s why a strike could be so disruptive for the global technology industry the dispute centres on how to distribute profits generated by soaring demand for ai memory chips at issue is the distribution of bonuses between staff in memory chip divisions and those in other units samsung had planned to pay generous bonuses to 27 000 staff making memory chips at least six times more than its workers making other chips and electronics the union said that 23 000 workers who were making less advanced chips

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generous bonuses to 27 000 staff making memory chips at least six times more than its workers making other chips and electronics the union said that 23 000 workers who were making less advanced chips for companies like tesla and nvidia should not be left behind it raised concerns over potential disruption to chip production with major implications for global supply chains and south korea s export driven economy samsung is the world s largest memory chipmaker by sales and a major supplier of chips used in ai data centres smartphones and laptops the broader samsung group accounts for roughly a fifth of south korea s economic output the dispute comes at a sensitive moment for the company as it faces intensifying competition from rivals sk hynix and micron amid surging ai driven chip demand that has already strained global supply samsung s operating profit in the january to march quarter jumped about 750 from a year earlier booming demand for ai chips pushed its stock market market

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that has already strained global supply samsung's operating profit in the january to march quarter jumped about 750 from a year earlier booming demand for ai chips pushed its stock market market valuation past 1tn 744bn in may last year rival sk hynix abolished its bonus pay cap for 10 years this led to bonuses more than three times higher than those offered to samsung employees some samsung workers jumped ship to sk hynix as a result samsung then proposed that memory chip workers receive bonuses of 60% of their annual salary higher than sk hynix according to transcripts of wage negotiations seen by reuters but employees in other businesses would only receive bonuses of 50 to 100 according to the documents the union also wanted samsung to abolish a bonus cap of 50% of annual salaries and allocate 15% of annual operating profit to a bonus pool distributed to workers samsung bosses previously flagged that the strike could impact south korea's economy more broadly because of lower sales

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allocate 15% of annual operating profit to a bonus pool distributed to workers. Samsung bosses previously flagged that the strike could impact South Korea's economy more broadly because of lower sales, investment outflows and lower tax revenue. In the statement issued after the tentative deal was agreed, the company said with a humble attitude: "we will build a more mature and constructive labour management relationship to ensure that such an incident never happens again." On Thursday, Samsung's shares rose by more than 8% after the announcement, while South Korea's Kospi stock index also jumped by over 8%. Such a strike could impact Samsung's operating profit by 21 trillion won to 31 trillion won (14.08bn to 20.79bn to 10.4bn to 15.4bn), according to JP Morgan, but any walkout is likely to be limited after a South Korean court granted Samsung Electronics an injunction. The court said staffing levels needed for safety, protection, facility damage prevention and product quality maintenance must remain at

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a south korean court granted samsung electronics an injunction the court said staffing levels needed for safety protection facility damage prevention and product quality maintenance must remain at normal levels to prevent damage to facilities and production it also barred the union and its leader from occupying or locking company facilities and obstructing workers from entering them the union would face fines of 74 000 a day if it breaches the order in today s interconnected global economy disruptions in strategically important industries can create ripple effects extending well beyond a single company or market the american chamber of commerce in korea said competing regional manufacturing markets could benefit if concerns over predictability and continuity persist campaigners in barbuda grenada and jamaica say they can no longer access their coastlines a north korean women s football team played in south korea marking the first time athletes from the north have crossed the border in

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grenada and jamaica say they can no longer access their coastlines a north korean women s football team played in south korea marking the first time athletes from the north have crossed the border in nearly 8 years learning assistants in the area are walking out for one day due to a row over how their jobs are graded the two sides will also work towards an extension to the tariffs truce they agreed in october china s commerce ministry said starbucks withdrew the campaign for its drink tumblers after many said it referenced a bloody crackdown copyright 2026 bbc all rights reserved the bbc is not responsible for the content of external sites read about our approach to external linking

Title: 'Think outside the bots': How to stop AI from turning your brain to mush

URL: <https://www.bbc.com/future/article/20260505-how-to-use-ai-without-turning-your-brain-to-mush>

gps ruined our sense of direction search engines weaken our memory ai scientists warn could do the same to everything from creativity to critical thinking years ago i forced myself to start using ai as often as possible if i was going to be writing about it i also had to use the technology but an emerging crop of studies over the last year or so have me worried am i harming my brain in the process these studies suggest people who lean too much on tools like chatgpt could have problems with creativity attention span critical thinking memory and more others raise concerns that ai users could be surrendering the cognitive friction that makes thinking sharp and that as a society we may have fewer original ideas but the science on this is brand new and we don t have the answers so should we be worried on a high level yes says adam green a professor of neuroscience and director of the laboratory for relational cognition at georgetown university in the us there s a lot of nuance here but ai

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worried on a high level yes says adam green a professor of neuroscience and director of the laboratory for relational cognition at georgetown university in the us there s a lot of nuance here but ai will do work that used to require mental labour there s plenty of evidence that if you are not doing as much of the actual thinking then your capability to do that kind of thinking is going to atrophy even if you don t seek to use chatgpt or claude there are ai responses at the top of google and tech giants are rushing to shove more of it onto our phones the technology is getting hard to avoid but there are steps you can take to avoid the biggest potential risks this isn t all or nothing though according to jared benge a professor and clinical neuropsychologist at dell medical school at the university of texas at austin using ai doesn t automatically mean it s going to be bad for you for example if ai frees up your brain space for other more important things that might be great for your

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university of texas at austin using ai doesn't automatically mean it's going to be bad for you for example if ai frees up your brain space for other more important things that might be great for your cognition why do we think ai is going to be that different from other things that our brain has already adapted to benge says it's not inherent to the tool to be good or bad as with any other technology how we use ai will determine whether it helps us or harms us but the concerns are serious enough that you might want to rethink how you use these tools before it's too late with this in mind i spoke with some leading experts in this field to find out how they think we should use ai to ensure it doesn't dull our minds twenty years ago an idea cropped up that overreliance on technology might cause some kind of digital dementia resulting in the deterioration of short term memory and other cognitive processes benge recently co-authored a meta-analysis that looked at 57 studies covering more

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some kind of digital dementia resulting in the deterioration of short term memory and other cognitive processes benge recently co authored a meta analysis that looked at 57 studies covering more than 411 000 adults all told he and his co author found no evidence for digital dementia technology use actually seemed to reduce the risk of cognitive impairment but that doesn t mean there s nothing to fear studies have found that people who rely on satellite navigation like gps stop building mental maps of their surroundings and their spatial memory continues to decline over time a similar phenomenon called the google effect emerged when search engines took over apparently we re less likely to remember information that we find using a search engine because it takes so little effort it seems the brain gets worse at tasks when we outsource them and ai is the most powerful outsourcing tool of all time what s happening with ai is that it s giving us for the first time an easy way to trade

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the brain gets worse at tasks when we outsource them and ai is the most powerful outsourcing tool of all time what s happening with ai is that it s giving us for the first time an easy way to trade process for product green says the essay can sound better the presentation can look sharper the retirement party joke can land perfectly but the mental work the struggle the false starts and that moment when something finally clicks is exactly what your brain needs it s like you re at the gym and a robot lifts the barbell for you he says you get nothing so how can you use ai and still give your brain a work out one recent study found heavier users of ai scored significantly worse on a standard critical thinking test apparently because they re used to offloading their thought processes to robots people even trust ai over their own thinking and intuition even when the ai is wrong something researchers at the university of pennsylvania in the us call cognitive surrender the problem gets worse

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people even trust ai over their own thinking and intuition even when the ai is wrong something researchers at the university of pennsylvania in the us call cognitive surrender the problem gets worse the less you know a study by microsoft research found you re most at risk when you re less familiar with as subject if the user doesn t have the expertise to judge whether the output is great or not says hank lee a phd candidate at carnegie mellon university who co authored the study that s the danger the fix starts before you open the app if you wouldn t trust a random stranger s answer to a question you shouldn t trust ai either says lee those are exactly the topics where you need to bring your own judgment first try forming a rough view on the subject and using ai to challenge your perspective before you get the robot s opinion that way ai is pressure testing your thinking rather than replacing it if you look at something it is in front of you and your vision sees it you often think it

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before you get the robot's opinion that way AI is pressure testing your thinking rather than replacing it. If you look at something it is in front of you and your vision sees it, you often think it's in long-term memory when it is not, says Barbara Oakley, an emeritus professor of engineering at the University of Oakland in the US who studies how the brain learns. There is some early research to suggest that AI can mess with your ability to retain information. A survey of 494 students also found that those who used ChatGPT more often were more likely to report memory loss. Self-reported assessments aren't hard science, but other research such as an unpublished 2024 study reveals that priming your brain with some light problem-solving before using an AI chatbot can improve what you learn from the AI. When you're asking AI for your information, you need to remember it's also worth slowing down to engage with it. Take notes ideally by hand, but typing them out works too. You can even ask the AI to quiz you or

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re asking ai for your information you need to remember it s also worth slowing down to engage with it take notes ideally by hand but typing them out works too you can even ask the ai to quiz you or to come up with flashcards the work makes it stick it sounds fussy but friction is the point ai is remarkably good at coming up with ideas that s the problem research suggests that people who use ai for creative tasks produce ideas that are more predictable and less original than people who don t this could be weakening your ability to be creative your brain builds creative capacity by making unexpected connections green says hand that job to ai and you skip the workout we re worried about losing your creative muscle says green ai is tricking us in a number of ways to make us think that it is actually making us more creative one approach to overcome this is to put your own ideas down on paper first even if they re rough spend more time with a blank page and write whatever comes the quality

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making us more creative one approach to overcome this is to put your own ideas down on paper first even if they're rough spend more time with a blank page and write whatever comes the quality doesn't matter what matters is that your brain is making the connections and reaching across your own experiences memories and knowledge to produce something only you could have come up with that's the workout then use AI to develop poke holes in or refine what you've got you've made it this far into the article well done but if your attention is starting to wander you're not alone it could be that my writing is boring you some research however also suggests the onslaught of technology is making it harder for us to focus AI could compound the problem answers are at your fingertips and with plenty of opportunities to skip difficulty and discomfort but you can apply a similar logic to the other tips here do things the slow way on purpose don't make ChatGPT summarise that long article sit with a

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of opportunities to skip difficulty and discomfort but you can apply a similar logic to the other tips here do things the slow way on purpose don't make chatgpt summarise that long article sit with a hard problem before you ask a robot let yourself get bored unpleasant is the goal that's your brain learning to tolerate and eventually enjoy the friction that deeper thinking requires i'm not here to tell you to stop using ai chatbots like chatgpt claude or gemini but i'm forcing myself to be more thoughtful when i reach for them to try and keep my brain in the driver's seat more like this why ai companies want you to be afraid of them can we predict when the next global crisis will hit this monkey selfie will protect you from ai slop and that could leave me and you in a better position in the future green says human brains are structurally different from ai in ways that really matter we make connections that are personal unexpected and genuinely novel in ways that digital probability

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the future green says human brains are structurally different from ai in ways that really matter we make connections that are personal unexpected and genuinely novel in ways that digital probability machines simply can't replicate the distinctness and diversity of human ideas is going to be the great value add in the coming years he says green predicts that forcing ourselves to think outside the bots will become a natural survival impulse to make it in society and as benge points out we've been down this road before our brains have always adapted to technology we adapt all the time it is our strength as a species he says have we lost the ability to run marathons because we have cars no it becomes something that humans do because we want to do it the tools change but apparently the desire to think create and figure things out for ourselves is harder to automate for timely trusted tech news from global correspondents to your inbox sign up to the tech decoded newsletter while the

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desire to think create and figure things out for ourselves is harder to automate for timely trusted tech news from global correspondents to your inbox sign up to the tech decoded newsletter while the essential list delivers a handpicked selection of features and insights twice a week for more science technology environment and health stories from the bbc follow us on facebook and instagram tech now heads to finland to meet the engineers designing icebreaker ships navigating through arctic sea ice tech now experiences lego s new smart brick designed to bring physical play to next level tech now meets a startup trying to fix one of the fashion industry s biggest blind spots inconsistent sizing a gold medalist has developed a vibrating starting block to give deaf athletes clearer fairer race starts in tokyo bbc techxplore tests live translation and ai powered displays that makes the city more navigable at tokyo s deaflympics deaf judo fans aren t just watching the matches they re feeling

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starts in tokyo bbc techxplore tests live translation and ai powered displays that makes the city more navigable at tokyo s deaflympics deaf judo fans aren t just watching the matches they re feeling them thanks to hapbeat bbc tech now takes us inside ces 2026 to meet musician will i am and his ai toy mofo tech now test out new gadgets disrupting the health industry at ces 2026 in las vegas musician kt tunstall meets her avatar as tech now explores music s virtual future discover how quirky clips paved the way for viral humour proving randomness never goes out of style a new research paper predicts ai autonomy by 2027 could lead to human extinction within a decade amid fears about the use of ai in classrooms american educator sal khan lays out an optimistic future british mathematician hannah fry digs into the science of touchscreens we explore how technology is reviving the renowned fiction writer s legacy why do flying fears persist despite falling accident rates learn tips to

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hannah fry digs into the science of touchscreens we explore how technology is reviving the renowned fiction writer s legacy why do flying fears persist despite falling accident rates learn tips to conquer your anxiety bbc click attend mobile world congress to test the latest tech products and trends bbc click visits a madrid hospital to see patients treated with an ultrasound for tremors bbc click speaks to the visual effects team behind the latest disney blockbuster bbc click meets tiktok creator peggy xu who gained millions of views sharing milk videos bbc click s paul carter visits the world s first fully ai powered hotel in las vegas robert jones 64 from york was caught littering on camera by a neighbour who alerted the council rising costs fuel volatility and global uncertainty aren t stopping americans from travelling this summer but they are changing what feels worth the money the chip giant reported more stellar results but its shares fell after hours as investors wonder if it

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stopping americans from travelling this summer but they are changing what feels worth the money the chip giant reported more stellar results but its shares fell after hours as investors wonder if it can keep up its pace of growth amid greater competition at first overlooked whistler s 1871 painting of his mother rose to fame over decades to become considered a national masterpiece a maternal figurehead and a diverse meme new materials designed by artificial intelligence promise to provide stronger hip replacements and improve how fractures heal copyright 2026 bbc all rights reserved the bbc is not responsible for the content of external sites read about our approach to external linking

Title: Robo-top: The machines that could make your next t-shirt

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they assemble cars perform surgery and even handle cargo at airports but give most robots a needle and thread and they would probably come undone that's why practically all the clothes sold in the world today are still made by hand often by very low paid workers in asia those workers may use tools such as sewing machines but fully automating such labour is difficult you have a problem if it's sewing says cam myers founder and chief executive of california based createme a robotics company you have to keep two pieces of fabric in alignment under motion his company takes another approach forget sewing glue the pieces of fabric together instead once the adhesive is laid down you simply line something over it and stamp createme has designed robots that do this and the firm is already making women's underwear this way it will begin producing t-shirts too in the coming months mass production could follow next year roboticists have eyed the garment manufacturing industry for decades if

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women's underwear this way it will begin producing t-shirts too in the coming months mass production could follow next year roboticists have eyed the garment manufacturing industry for decades if machines could ever take over such work clothes making could come back to countries in the west and the environmental footprint of garments might be slashed in the process but millions of textile workers could also be out of a job just a few percent of clothes sold today in the UK are made here it's a similar story in the US Myers says he has customers seeking to market garments as made in the US with US produced cotton for example we can use cotton we can use wool we can use leather he says of CreateMe's adhesive based process if just 10% of t-shirt manufacturing moved back to the US with the help of automation that would be a huge industry shift he adds the adhesive CreateMe uses is thermoset which means that ironing or washing machine temperatures aren't enough to melt it and make the

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help of automation that would be a huge industry shift he adds the adhesive create me uses is thermoset which means that ironing or washing machine temperatures aren't enough to melt it and make the clothes fall apart insists myers he adds that because these garments lack seams they are streamlined and can also be manufactured on moulds that capture the contours of the human body even myers acknowledges that a key challenge in apparel is that it is high flex in other words you won't get very far if you just make white t-shirts customers like choosing from an endless array of garments with varying form factors colours and designs clothes producing robots are still a long way from doing all that and there remains a debate over the fundamentals we don't believe that sewing is going away says palaniswamy rajan chairman and chief executive of softwear automation based in the us state of georgia he points out that visible stitching is a key component in the design of many fashionable

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says palaniswamy rajan chairman and chief executive of softwear automation based in the us state of georgia he points out that visible stitching is a key component in the design of many fashionable garments perhaps most famously jeans rajan says that his company will soon announce the third generation of its sewing robots which he claims will make t shirts at the same cost as importing them to the us however he declines to discuss any details about the technology multiple firms that spoke to the bbc for this article were reluctant to share information about how their robots work such is the competition for a slice of the giant apparel market meanwhile textile workers are already under pressure having faced factory closures during the covid 19 pandemic and more recently the war in iran which has hit polyester supplies automation industry representatives often suggest that workers should aim for better paying less repetitive jobs but simply handing t shirt production to robots won t do

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has hit polyester supplies automation industry representatives often suggest that workers should aim for better paying less repetitive jobs but simply handing t shirt production to robots won't do that overnight one key benefit of automating garment manufacturing however is that it could drastically reduce the environmental impact of this industry every year 92 million tonnes of textile waste is produced globally huge volumes of unsold clothes are incinerated and the apparel industry also consumes vast amounts of water if you can re-shore the manufacturing part you can just produce there on demand says gerald feichtinger at the technical university of leoben in austria he recently led a study that analysed whether such on demand manufacturing could reduce overproduction of garments and slash the carbon emissions associated with transporting them from asia to europe for example we can see a significant reduction in greenhouse gas emissions he adds the paper found that emissions

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and slash the carbon emissions associated with transporting them from asia to europe for example we can see a significant reduction in greenhouse gas emissions he adds the paper found that emissions associated with making a t shirt could fall by roughly 45 when a robot produced the garment in europe or the us for their study the researchers collaborated with an austria based garment making robot company called silana and one of the co authors previously worked for that company though separate research has made similar findings there are other ways to reduce the environmental impact of clothing such as simply extending the life of garments claims around automation lowering the environmental impact of textiles should be balanced against the fact that other parts of the supply chain such as dyeing of fabric or the production of yarn may not be so easy to re shore feichtinger and his colleagues study acknowledges these factors and he says re shoring multiple parts of the garment supply

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dyeing of fabric or the production of yarn may not be so easy to re shore feichtinger and his colleagues study acknowledges these factors and he says re shoring multiple parts of the garment supply chain remains challenging michael fraede is co founder of german firm robotextile which makes gripper devices that enable robots to deftly pick up pieces of fabric some of them work by gently blowing air across the fabric making it flutter and lift so that it can then be sucked towards a gripper and clamped into place for example fraede says the market for automating textile production in europe is likely limited to specialist textiles such as those used for bicycle bags or airbags in cars his company s robots have helped to make both such products among others it will take 10 more years before we see the first actions of re shoring he says this industry is not used to thinking that way they are used to saving money wherever they can others are more hopeful lauren junestrand innovation and

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we see the first actions of re shoring he says this industry is not used to thinking that way they are used to saving money wherever they can others are more hopeful lauren junestrand innovation and sustainability network manager at the uk fashion and textile association says the uk has huge potential to incorporate robotics garment makers are using more and more robots for various tasks already she adds but even junestrand says that countries such as the uk will probably never be able to compete with competitors in asia in terms of volume i think it s going to be more of a co existence she adds the walkout which was due to start on thursday has been suspended while union members vote on a tentative deal campaigners in barbuda grenada and jamaica say they can no longer access their coastlines the two sides will also work towards an extension to the tariffs truce they agreed in october china s commerce ministry said the uk headquartered banking giant aims to move some of the effected

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the two sides will also work towards an extension to the tariffs truce they agreed in october china s commerce ministry said the uk headquartered banking giant aims to move some of the effected workers to other roles in the business energy markets have been on a wild ride as the key strait of hormuz waterway remains effectively closed copyright 2026 bbc all rights reserved the bbc is not responsible for the content of external sites read about our approach to external linking

Title: The fight against foreign developers buying Caribbean beaches

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on the small caribbean island of barbuda the pink sands beach bar played host to locals and the occasional tourist for more than 20 years it was a very warm place says miranda beazer its former owner describing how people used to gather there to play dominoes or to relax after church on sundays named after the rose tinted sand it stood on the bar was a cornerstone of the local community until hurricane irma hit the island in 2017 when all of the roughly 2 000 barbudans were evacuated to sister island antigua miranda s bar and her house were destroyed there s nobody that was unscathed it was devastating i cried for two weeks she says before the bar could be rebuilt her husband died foreign developers started to offer her large amounts of money for her plot but she refused them all it s not the money that i m after miranda says i actually want to retain my land then the bulldozers came what remained of the bar after the hurricane was demolished by foreign developers miranda alleges since

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money that i m after miranda says i actually want to retain my land then the bulldozers came what remained of the bar after the hurricane was demolished by foreign developers miranda alleges since then miranda has been fighting a legal case to regain access to what she argues is her land however this is complicated by antigua and barbuda s property laws land ownership in barbuda is collective meaning that individual citizens have the right to occupy a plot of land by applying for a lease but technically they do not privately own it instead all land is owned communally and citizens share the collective right to be consulted and to have the final say on major developments the ownership system was established after slavery ended in barbuda in 1834 and was officially recognised by the government of antigua and barbuda in 2007 when the barbuda land act was passed miranda says she owns the lease to 30 acres of coastline but currently she only has access to eight the global legal action

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of antigua and barbuda in 2007 when the barbuda land act was passed miranda says she owns the lease to 30 acres of coastline but currently she only has access to eight the global legal action network glan a network of lawyers that is supporting her says the rest of the land is being illegally occupied by foreign developers murbee resorts and peace love and happiness plh in a statement murbee says that it is a legal lease holder in barbuda and has not carried out construction activity on any land for which it does not have legal authority to do so or at all plh says it does not and has never occupied the land and has strictly followed all agreements since entering a lease for land in barbuda in february 2017 but miranda says like many other barbudan campaigners that she remains committed to fighting for access if you were to ever come here and experience it yourself you would really understand why we re so committed to this little piece of rock that we have miranda s land is the last

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to fighting for access if you were to ever come here and experience it yourself you would really understand why we're so committed to this little piece of rock that we have. Miranda's land is the last strip of Barbuda's southern coastline that is still accessible to locals but like many beaches on islands across the Caribbean where locals are not protected by property laws it is now under threat from wealthy developers who want to turn it into an exclusive retreat reserved solely for tourists. One property investor just a few miles down the coast from Miranda's plot is the Oscar-winning actor Robert De Niro along with the Australian billionaire James Packer. He is part of Paradise Found, the developers of the Beach Club Barbuda, this sprawling 400-acre resort which is due to be completed later this year. It will include Nobu Beach Inn, a luxury hotel made up of 17 villas. There will also be 25 beach front homes. Locals say they can no longer visit or even see the beach. The resort is built on

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this year will include nobu beach inn a luxury hotel made up of 17 villas there will also be 25 beach front homes locals say they can no longer visit or even see the beach the resort is built on after a bypass road that was recently built to ringfence the complex the price of a plot on the beach club site is said to start from 7m 5 2m on its website the resort is described as a rare island community on one of the caribbean s last untouched shores but john mussington the chairperson of barbuda council the local authority argues that this community was only made possible by flouting the 2007 land act to allow construction of the beach club to go ahead the government passed a new law the paradise found act in 2015 it stipulates that the 2007 act does not apply to the beach club complex campaigners mounted a legal challenge which was taken all the way to the highest court for antigua and barbuda the judicial committee of the privy council jcpc in the uk antigua and barbuda maintained this

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mounted a legal challenge which was taken all the way to the highest court for Antigua and Barbuda the judicial committee of the privy council JCPC in the UK. Antigua and Barbuda maintained this legal structure after it gained its independence from the UK in 1981. In 2022 the JCPC found in favour of the Antiguan and Barbudan government ruling that the rights accorded to individual Barbudans solely on account of their status as Barbudans do not constitute an interest in or right over property. Paradise Found said in a statement that the beach club was developed in accordance with the laws and approval processes of Antigua and Barbuda and that public access to Princess Diana Beach which is now part of the complex remains unchanged. Barbuda is not the only Caribbean island where colonial era laws sit at the heart of land disputes. Head 1 600 km 1 000 miles west and there is another long running campaign for greater access to beaches for locals in Jamaica. Devon Taylor, president of the Jamaica

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sit at the heart of land disputes head 1 600 km 1 000 miles west and there is another long running campaign for greater access to beaches for locals in jamaica devon taylor president of the jamaica beach birthright environmental movement jabbem says the country s current land legislation discriminates against jamaicans as it clearly states we have no rights in or over the foreshore the jamaican government recently proposed a new law to improve beach access for locals but taylor argues that instead of improving jamaicans land rights it places more restrictions on where they can go by encouraging hotels to sell beach passes to locals you re selling back the access to the people he says adding that he believes this takes the country back to a kind of colonial logic the jamaican government has been approached for comment according to jabbem less than 1 of jamaica s coastline remains freely accessible to locals along with other local groups they are currently fighting the jamaican

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has been approached for comment according to jabbem less than 1 of jamaica s coastline remains freely accessible to locals along with other local groups they are currently fighting the jamaican government and private developers in five separate legal challenges over beach access for locals as tourists start to look further afield seeking out less well known destinations smaller caribbean islands such as grenada are also seeing legal disputes kriss davies chairperson of the campaign group grenada land actors fears that as demand grows the arrival of more large resorts could make grenada lose the charm that makes it unique for locals and tourists alike according to the united nations development programme the caribbean is the most tourism dependent region in the world of all the holidaymakers to the region roughly half are american for governments across the region the continuing growth of the sector offers an enticing path towards economic growth and development but as devon says

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to the region roughly half are american for governments across the region the continuing growth of the sector offers an enticing path towards economic growth and development but as devon says travel is never neutral it carries both an economic and moral weight these developments often displace residents from ancestral coastlines restrict public access to beaches and channel wealth away from the very people whose culture sustains the tourism experience as the demand for a portion of paradise only continues to grow caribbean land defenders remain concerned that rather than bringing opportunity tourism could irrevocably change the place they call home these powerful tropical storms are generally becoming more intense as the world warms an increase in tourists from the republic has been the most prominent feature of northern ireland s post pandemic tourism bounce back the walkout which was due to start on thursday has been suspended while union members vote on a tentative deal the head of

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prominent feature of northern ireland s post pandemic tourism bounce back the walkout which was due to start on thursday has been suspended while union members vote on a tentative deal the head of one of nigeria s biggest energy companies says iran tensions have boosted demand for african oil jason mckelvie says stirrups hotel could see its annual rates rise by almost 150k over the next three years copyright 2026 bbc all rights reserved the bbc is not responsible for the content of external sites read about our approach to external linking

Title: They hear, but do they care? What AI can teach us about listening better

URL: <https://www.bbc.com/future/article/20251218-how-ai-can-teach-us-to-really-listen>

ai chatbots don't interrupt and aren't judgemental so what can they teach us about deep listening i am aware it's a machine but it's super convenient and knows how to listen well whenever i need it says anna a ukrainian living in london she is talking about her regular use of the premium version of chatgpt a chatbot powered by artificial intelligence what anna the bbc is not using her real name to protect her identity finds particularly valuable isn't necessarily the ai's advice but its ability to give her space for self reflection i have a history with it so i can rely on it to always understand my issues and communicate with me in a way that suits me she says she is aware that this might seem odd to many people including her friends and family which is why she has asked to remain anonymous but when she recently broke up with her boyfriend she found the ai's patient listening offered something that her protective friends and family couldn't provide with their immediate judgments about

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but when she recently broke up with her boyfriend she found the ai s patient listening offered something that her protective friends and family couldn t provide with their immediate judgments about her ex partner he s an idiot instead the absence of judgement created an opportunity for self understanding as she unpacked her mixed emotions and anna is not alone recent harvard business review research shows that in 2025 therapy and companionship was the single most common use of generative ai through the family of tools like chatgpt which can carry out a conversation much like a person strikingly studies show ai generated text responses are now rated as more compassionate than those written by humans even when those humans are trained responders from crisis hotlines this isn t because ai is genuinely more compassionate but rather a sobering indictment of how rarely we listen in a non judgmental way when researchers disclosed the identity of the response authors evaluators still judged

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genuinely more compassionate but rather a sobering indictment of how rarely we listen in a non judgmental way when researchers disclosed the identity of the response authors evaluators still judged responses from chatgpt responses to be more understanding validating and caring revealing how hungry people are for uninterrupted non defensive listening in another study people reported experiencing more hope less distress and less discomfort after interacting with ai generated responses compared to humans it is worth remembering that these ai chatbots are not displaying real empathy but rather simulating it based on what they have learned from huge datasets of human interactions the irony that an algorithm powered by a large language model the type of machine learning that underpins many ai chatbots might be perceived as a better listener than an authentic human reveals important insights about our human listening shortcomings it s when our agendas backstories and emotional triggers run

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chatbots might be perceived as a better listener than an authentic human reveals important insights about our human listening shortcomings it's when our agendas backstories and emotional triggers run the show that true deep listening becomes thwarted none of this is to suggest we should trade real person relationships for large language models but it does suggest there are some lessons that we humans can learn from these code based listeners ai v the mind this article is part of ai v the mind a series that aims to explore the limits of cutting edge ai and learn a little about how our own brains work along the way with some expert help each article pits different ai tools against the human mind asking probing questions designed to test the limits of intelligence can a machine write a better joke than a professional comedian or unpick a moral conundrum more elegantly than a philosopher we hope to find out perhaps the most fundamental lesson from ai is simply allowing others to speak

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joke than a professional comedian or unpick a moral conundrum more elegantly than a philosopher we hope to find out perhaps the most fundamental lesson from ai is simply allowing others to speak without interruption humans interrupt for countless reasons fear of an awkward silence attempts to help find words saving time with our superior responses or sub consciously asserting dominance these interruptions however well intended rob speakers of their autonomy and opportunity to develop their thoughts interruptions during a phone conversation for example have been found to lessen perception of empathy in the person speaking large language models don t have motivations or desires they are programmed to be compliant so that people will continue to use them they therefore exhibit perpetual patience never suffering from empathy fatigue while such a feat is not something we humans can or should aspire to holding back from interruptions can be powerful pioneering psychologist carl rogers

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patience never suffering from empathy fatigue while such a feat is not something we humans can or should aspire to holding back from interruptions can be powerful pioneering psychologist carl rogers understood that acknowledging emotions is essential to effective listening large language models are programmed to categorise emotions and reflect these back in what appears to be an empathetic way according to anat perry an empathy researcher at hebrew university in jerusalem in israel one experiment found that bing chat the forerunner to microsoft s copilot was more accurate than human responders in detecting happiness sadness fear and disgust it was comparable to humans in detecting anger and surprise while large language models can t actually feel these emotions they can recognise and reflect back these sentiments so the speaker feels heard researchers have found that ai platforms that reflect emotional complexity in their responses can help to reframe users thinking and build

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and reflect back these sentiments so the speaker feels heard researchers have found that ai platforms that reflect emotional complexity in their responses can help to reframe users thinking and build psychological resilience humans instinctively avoid acknowledging difficult emotions both our own and others so for example when our cousin tells us about the tragic death of his cat we jump in to reassure with comments such as luna had a long happy life and was well loved till the end but this fails to acknowledge our cousin s feelings of distress ai systems show particular advantage in responding to scenarios involving suffering and sadness compared to positive emotions people often fear burdening human listeners with their worries explains dariya ovsyannikova a cognitive health researcher at the university of toronto canada who has studied how people perceive ai as compassionate ai offers a burden free alternative giving someone the space to share tough emotions can allow a speaker to

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at the university of toronto canada who has studied how people perceive ai as compassionate ai offers a burden free alternative giving someone the space to share tough emotions can allow a speaker to feel it s safe to have difficult thoughts and thus more likely to be able to move beyond them our survival as a species has historically depended on making quick judgments distinguishing friend from foe is an evolutionary imperative but these judgments often unconsciously conveyed through subtle expressions like a momentary frown can be devastating for someone sharing vulnerable thoughts this has been found to be especially true among young children for example in contrast ai seems to offer users anonymity and freedom from social judgement creating psychological safety that enables open sharing for human listeners this highlights how critical it is to recognise when you are making judgements and consciously set them aside so your speaker can feel open to share more freely because of

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sharing for human listeners this highlights how critical it is to recognise when you are making judgements and consciously set them aside so your speaker can feel open to share more freely because of everything we are juggling a non professional listener isn't focussed on recalling different types of anxiety that someone has told us about for example or the multiple feelings they've expressed about their mother AI algorithms excel at pattern recognition drawing upon a vast array of data including incoherent thoughts to pick up the slimmest threads and weave them into a meaning rich tapestry when we listen as a human we too can choose to take a step back and reflect back to the speaker not every instance of repetitive emotions but an overall sense of what they feel about an issue and even their feelings about holding these emotions these patterns can be like a gift if they offer us the opportunity to draw meaning from them or see our story in a new light narrative is a crucial way in

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their feelings about holding these emotions these patterns can be like a gift if they offer us the opportunity to draw meaning from them or see our story in a new light narrative is a crucial way in which humans make sense of the world many of us particularly in leadership or parental roles believe our value lies in sharing the pearls of our wisdom and offering helpful advice and men are more likely than women to jump in unsolicited to provide solutions to fix someone else's problems yet in studies AI's restraint from offering practical suggestions in favour of emotional support makes people feel heard more effectively something humans can consciously choose to do when someone shares their challenging experience a miscarriage an impossible boss a leak in their roof we so often respond with our own similar story we might feel it conveys a sense that we know how they feel and that it can help to build a connection with the other person but in doing so we are turning the spotlight away

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our own similar story we might feel it conveys a sense that we know how they feel and that it can help to build a connection with the other person but in doing so we are turning the spotlight away from them and onto us when we start to tell our story we stop listening to theirs a large language model can not fall into this trap because it has no experiences humans can which is why we can choose to be more intentional about keeping the spotlight on the speaker not reverting to our own story despite these advantages there are also a multitude of dangers of over reliance on ai as a listening tool as technology advances towards human like avatars who look sound and feel like our fantasy listener even conveying tactile responses both potential benefits and dangers increase more like this how we tested ai s ability to apologise why indian cinema is awash with ai the riddles that computers can t solve michael inzlicht a psychologist at the university of toronto in canada researching ai and

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we tested ai's ability to apologise why indian cinema is awash with ai the riddles that computers can't solve michael inzlicht a psychologist at the university of toronto in canada researching ai and empathy warns of the power of ai companies to potentially manipulate vulnerable people ai can give dangerous advice leading in some cases to individuals taking their own lives they can also cause a person to prioritise a relationship with a bot rather than fostering a more meaningful connection with another human being becoming accustomed to boundless empathy and 24/7 positive interest in them regardless of what they say people interacting with a large language model may also become deskilled and unable or less motivated to pursue human interactions with a host of challenging implications for our broader societies inzlicht suggests as a first step large language models could be fine tuned to introduce appropriate friction in conversations helping users develop greater awareness of others

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our broader societies inzicht suggests as a first step large language models could be fine tuned to introduce appropriate friction in conversations helping users develop greater awareness of others needs there remains something uniquely meaningful about a fellow human sacrificing their time and other competing desires to simply listen and let someone else unfold their story the conscious choice to be present for another person enacts a form of connection compassion and companionship fundamentally different from interactions with lines of code programmed to please without the capacity for genuine care ai can certainly inspire us to become better listeners and even help train us in greater compassion it can serve a valuable resource if there are appropriate safeguards in place for those who have no one to turn to however the experience of deeply listening to another human with curiosity to understand their full humanity and being listened to in return has a transformative potential

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who have no one to turn to however the experience of deeply listening to another human with curiosity to understand their full humanity and being listened to in return has a transformative potential that ai interactions cannot yet match and as anyone who has ever experienced the transformative impact of feeling truly heard by another human being will realise it may never do so emily kasriel is the author of deep listening transform your relationships with family friends and foes and a senior visiting research fellow at king s college london for more technology news and insights sign up to our tech decoded newsletter while the essential list delivers a handpicked selection of features and insights to your inbox twice a week for more science technology environment and health stories from the bbc follow us on facebook and instagram tech now heads to finland to meet the engineers designing icebreaker ships navigating through arctic sea ice tech now experiences lego s new smart brick

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the bbc follow us on facebook and instagram tech now heads to finland to meet the engineers designing icebreaker ships navigating through arctic sea ice tech now experiences lego's new smart brick designed to bring physical play to next level tech now meets a startup trying to fix one of the fashion industry's biggest blind spots inconsistent sizing a gold medalist has developed a vibrating starting block to give deaf athletes clearer fairer race starts in tokyo bbc techxplore tests live translation and ai powered displays that makes the city more navigable at tokyo's deaflympics deaf judo fans aren't just watching the matches they're feeling them thanks to hapbeat bbc tech now takes us inside ces 2026 to meet musician will i am and his ai toy mofo tech now test out new gadgets disrupting the health industry at ces 2026 in las vegas musician kt tunstall meets her avatar as tech now explores music's virtual future rollercoasters send our hearts racing and stomachs dropping hannah fry

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the health industry at ces 2026 in las vegas musician kt tunstall meets her avatar as tech now explores music s virtual future rollercoasters send our hearts racing and stomachs dropping hannah fry dives into the science of how they work discover how quirky clips paved the way for viral humour proving randomness never goes out of style we find out how ai blurs the line between creation and automation raising questions about the essence of art a new research paper predicts ai autonomy by 2027 could lead to human extinction within a decade amid fears about the use of ai in classrooms american educator sal khan lays out an optimistic future british mathematician hannah fry digs into the science of touchscreens we explore how technology is reviving the renowned fiction writer s legacy why do flying fears persist despite falling accident rates learn tips to conquer your anxiety black holes are one of the mysteries of the universe where all the laws of nature as we know them stop working

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flying fears persist despite falling accident rates learn tips to conquer your anxiety black holes are one of the mysteries of the universe where all the laws of nature as we know them stop working bbc click visits a uk research team working on a solution to remove toxic chemicals known as pfas from water bbc click attend mobile world congress to test the latest tech products and trends robert jones 64 from york was caught littering on camera by a neighbour who alerted the council rising costs fuel volatility and global uncertainty aren t stopping americans from travelling this summer but they are changing what feels worth the money the chip giant reported more stellar results but its shares fell after hours as investors wonder if it can keep up its pace of growth amid greater competition at first overlooked whistler s 1871 painting of his mother rose to fame over decades to become considered a national masterpiece a maternal figurehead and a diverse meme new materials designed by

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at first overlooked whistler s 1871 painting of his mother rose to fame over decades to become considered a national masterpiece a maternal figurehead and a diverse meme new materials designed by artificial intelligence promise to provide stronger hip replacements and improve how fractures heal copyright 2026 bbc all rights reserved the bbc is not responsible for the content of external sites read about our approach to external linking

Title: University of Lincoln AI stand wins award at Chelsea Flower Show

URL: <https://www.bbc.com/news/articles/cvgzr935jvmo>

an exhibition featuring a health scan for plants has won an award at the chelsea flower show created by the university of lincoln the robocrops plant selection beyond the visible display includes a combination of robotics plant science and artificial intelligence the project monitors a plant s growth structure and health as well as signs of stress and disease invisible to the human eye the stand attracted interest from visitors including london mayor sadiq khan and was awarded a silver gilt medal by the show the exhibit was presented by the university of lincoln s institute for agri food technology within the show s greenstem zone when he visited the stand at the show khan discussed the future potential of the technology the university said prof simon pearson founding director of the institute said one of the most rewarding aspects we ve already seen this week has been the level of curiosity and engagement from visitors particularly young people around how robotics ai and plant science

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said one of the most rewarding aspects we've already seen this week has been the level of curiosity and engagement from visitors particularly young people around how robotics ai and plant science can work together to address some of the major challenges facing horticulture and food production listen to highlights from lincolnshire on bbc sounds and watch the latest episode of look north download the bbc news app from the app store for iphone and ipad or google play for android devices former pc alan kirkwood would have had a final warning if he had still been a serving officer lincolnshire county council said the crash on tritton road had left the equipment unsafe the pleasure garden is one of the projects exploring social themes and targeting new audiences the firm that grew it says the flower also represents the very best of british rose breeding london's largest free flower festival returns to chelsea with a cosmic out of this world theme copyright 2026 bbc all rights reserved the

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flower also represents the very best of british rose breeding london s largest free flower festival returns to chelsea with a cosmic out of this world theme copyright 2026 bbc all rights reserved the bbc is not responsible for the content of external sites read about our approach to external linking